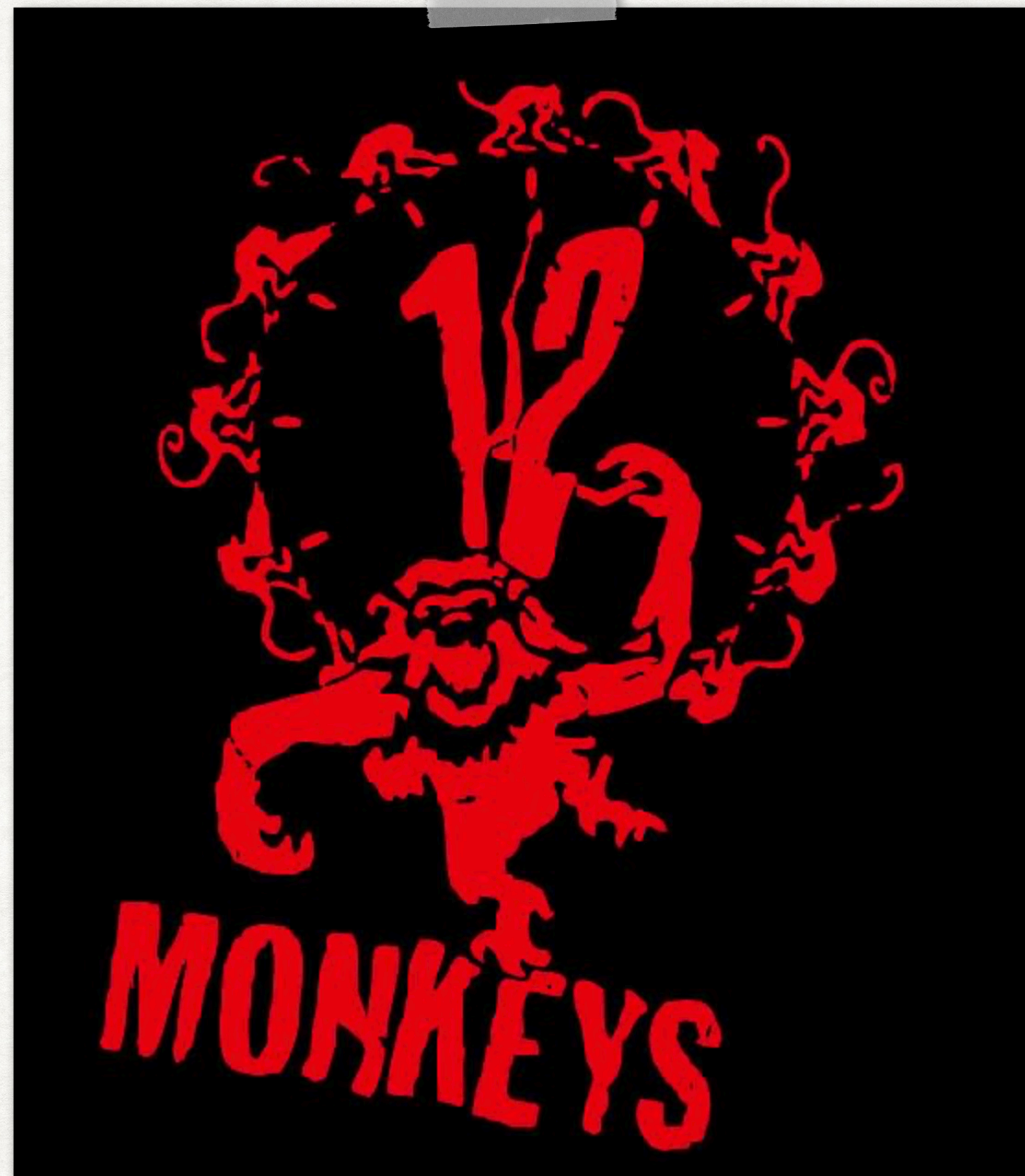


COM 3240

REINFORCEMENT LEARNING



“

**FUTURE ACTIONS DO NOT AFFECT
THE PAST.**

— *Common experience*

”



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PROBABILITIES

LIKELIHOOD THAT AN EVENT WILL OCCUR

$$P(A)$$

$$0 \leq P(A) \leq 1$$

Sample space $S = \{\text{all possible outcomes}\}$

$$P(S) = 1$$



Example d4: Rolls 1 to 4

RPROBABILITIES

RANDOM VARIABLES

Variables that can assume different values,
each with a certain probability.



Example d4: Rolls 1 to 4

$$P(X = x)$$

$$P(X = 1) \quad P(X = 2) \quad P(X = 3) \quad P(X = 4)$$

PROBABILITIES

PROBABILITY DISTRIBUTION



Example d4: Rolls 1 to 4 with equal probability (if fair)

$$P(X = x) = \frac{1}{4}, \quad x \in \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$$

uniform probability distribution

A probability distribution specifies how probabilities are distributed over the values of a random variable.

PROBABILITIES

EXPECTATION



Example d4: Rolls 1 to 4 with equal probability (if fair)

uniform probability distribution

$$E[X] = \sum_x x \cdot P(X = x)$$

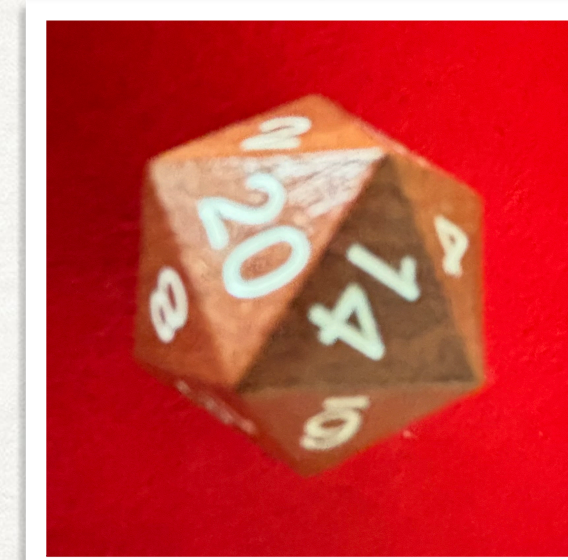
$$E[X] = \frac{1}{4}(1 + 2 + 3 + 4) = 2.5$$

Expected Reward

PROBABILITIES

JOINT PROBABILITY

$$P(X = x, Y = y) = P(\{X = x\} \cap \{Y = y\})$$



$$P(X = x, Y = y) \geq 0$$

$$\sum_x \sum_y P(X = x, Y = y) = 1.$$

PROBABILITIES

JOINT PROBABILITY FOR INDEPENDENT VARIABLES

$$\begin{aligned} P(X = x, Y = y) &= P(\{X = x\} \cap \{Y = y\}) \\ &= P(X = x) \cdot P(Y = y) \end{aligned}$$



Dice rolls

PROBABILITIES

JOINT PROBABILITY DISTRIBUTION

$$P(X = x, Y = y) = P(\{X = x\} \cap \{Y = y\})$$



$$P(X = x, Y = y) \geq 0$$

Describes the probabilities of all possible combinations of outcomes for variables X and Y (e.g. in a table).

$$\sum_x \sum_y P(X = x, Y = y) = 1.$$

EXAMPLE

ROLLING TWO DICES

Dungeons & Dragons

To hit: roll 1d20

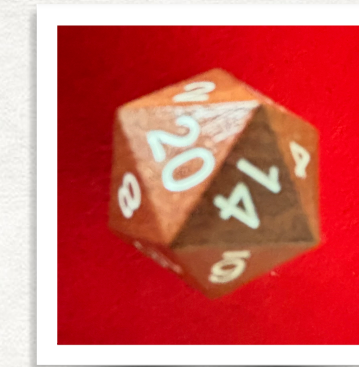
Advantage: roll 2 Dices

Assume known: probably p to hit with one roll

Calculate the probability to hit with advantage



Consider the joint probability of hitting your opponent when rolling two dices



First dice hits but not the second

$$p(1-p)$$

Second dice hits but not the first

$$(1-p)p$$

Both dices hit

$$p \cdot p$$

None hits

$$(1-p) \cdot (1-p)$$

$$p_{hit} = p$$

Sum 1

joint probability distribution

PROBABILITIES

PROPERTIES OF EXPECTATION

$$E[aX + bY] = aE[X] + bE[Y]$$

Linearity

$$E[XY] = E[X] \cdot E[Y]$$

Expectation of products for independent variables

$$E[c] = c$$

PROBABILITIES

VARIANCE

Definition: $\mathbf{Var}(X) = E \left[(X - E[X])^2 \right]$

$$\mathbf{Var}(X) = E[X^2] - (E[X])^2$$

Easy to show, using the properties of expectation

BURNING HANDS

1st level evocation

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: Self (15-foot cone)

Target: Self (15-foot cone)

Components: V S

Duration: Instantaneous

Classes: Sorcerer, Wizard

As you hold your hands with thumbs touching and fingers spread, a thin sheet of flames shoots forth from your outstretched fingertips. Each creature in a 15-foot cone must make a Dexterity saving throw. A creature takes 3d6 fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. The fire ignites any flammable objects in the area that aren't being worn or carried.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 2nd level or higher, the damage increases by 1d6 for each slot level above 1st.

https://roll20.net/compendium/dnd5e/Burning_Hands#content

MAGIC MISSILE

1st level evocation

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 120 feet

Target: A creature of your choice that you can see within range

Components: V S

Duration: Instantaneous

Classes: Sorcerer, Wizard

You create three glowing darts of magical force. Each dart hits a creature of your choice that you can see within range. A dart deals 1d4 + 1 force damage to its target. The darts all strike simultaneously, and you can direct them to hit one creature or several.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 2nd level or higher, the spell creates one more dart for each slot above 1st.

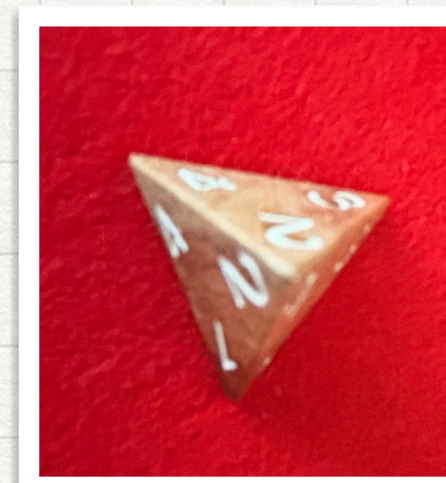
[https://roll20.net/compendium/dnd5e/Magic Missile#content](https://roll20.net/compendium/dnd5e/Magic%20Missile#content)

Calculate the expected (average) damage

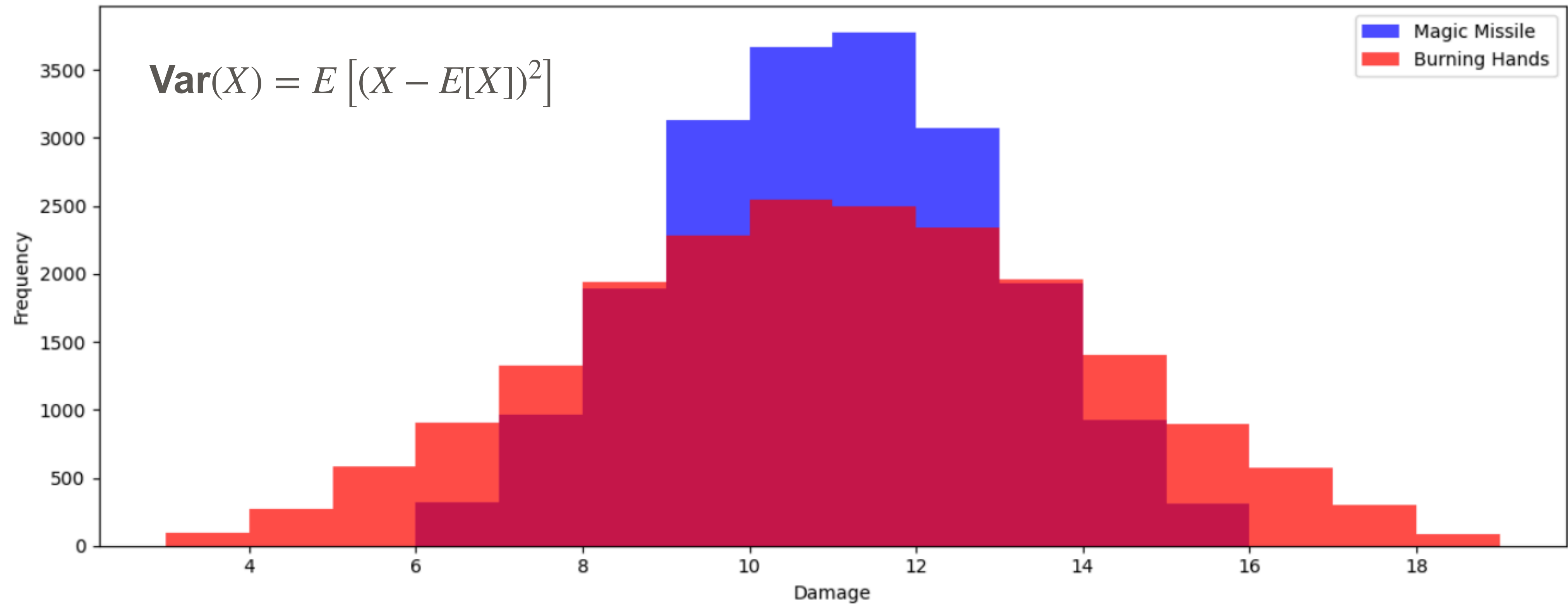
Burning hands: 3d6



Magic missile: 3 x (1d4+1)



Damage Distribution Comparison



Magic Missile – Mean Damage: 10.493, Variance: 3.782051

Burning Hands – Mean Damage: 10.5193, Variance: 8.74442751

MEAN AND VARIANCE

CONSIDERATIONS FOR THE REWARD

Option 1: low reward with high probability (low variance)

Option 2: high reward with low probability (high variance)

Trapped in local minima



PROBABILITIES

PROPERTIES OF CONDITIONAL EXPECTATIONS

$$E[X | Y = y] = \sum_x x \cdot P(X = x | Y = y)$$

$$E[X] = E[E[X | Y]]$$

Law of Total Expectation

$$E[aX + bY | Z] = aE[X | Z] + bE[Y | Z]$$

Linearity

$$E[X | Y] = E[X]$$

Independence



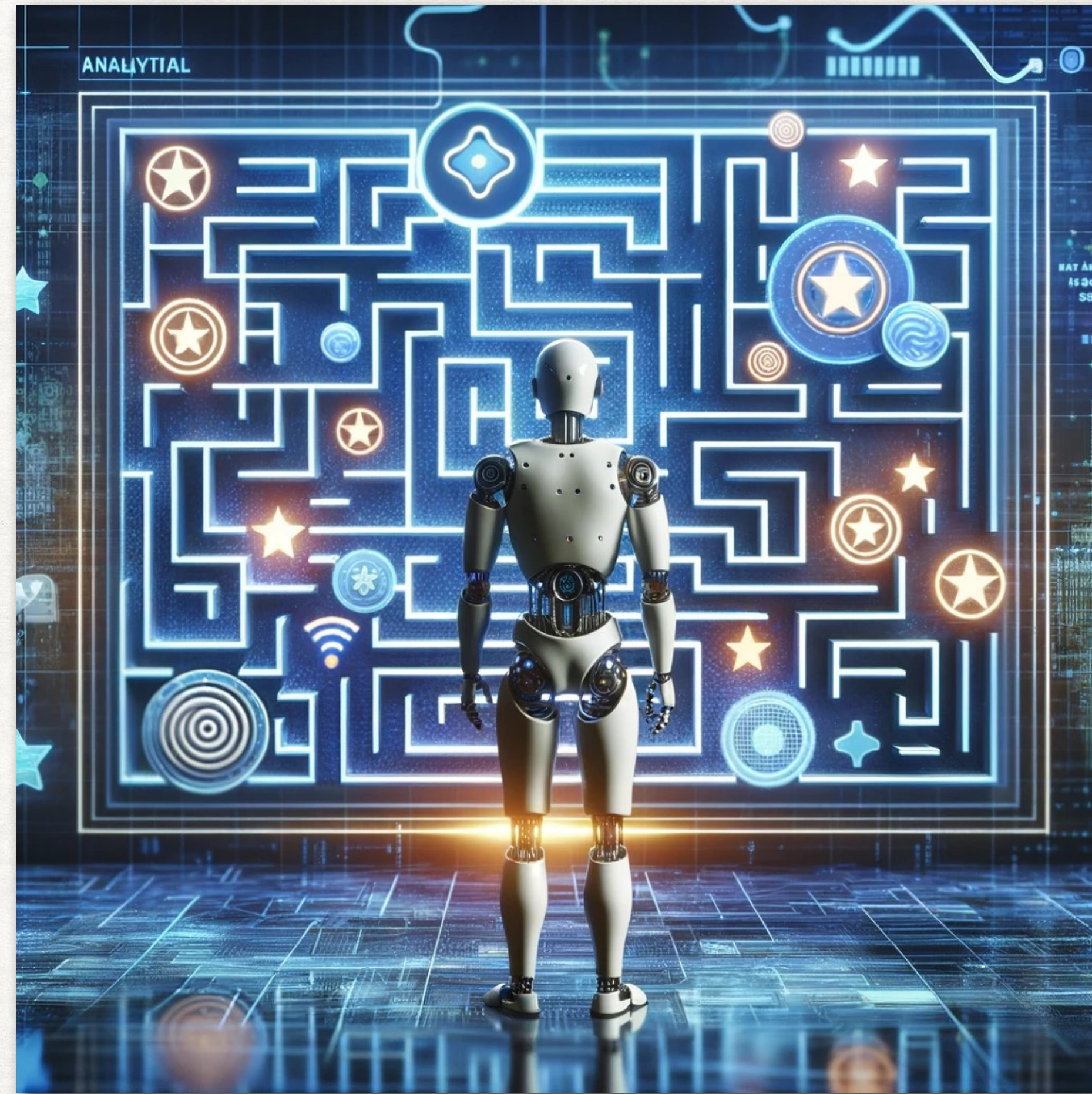
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PROBABILITY, EXPECTATION, VARIANCE

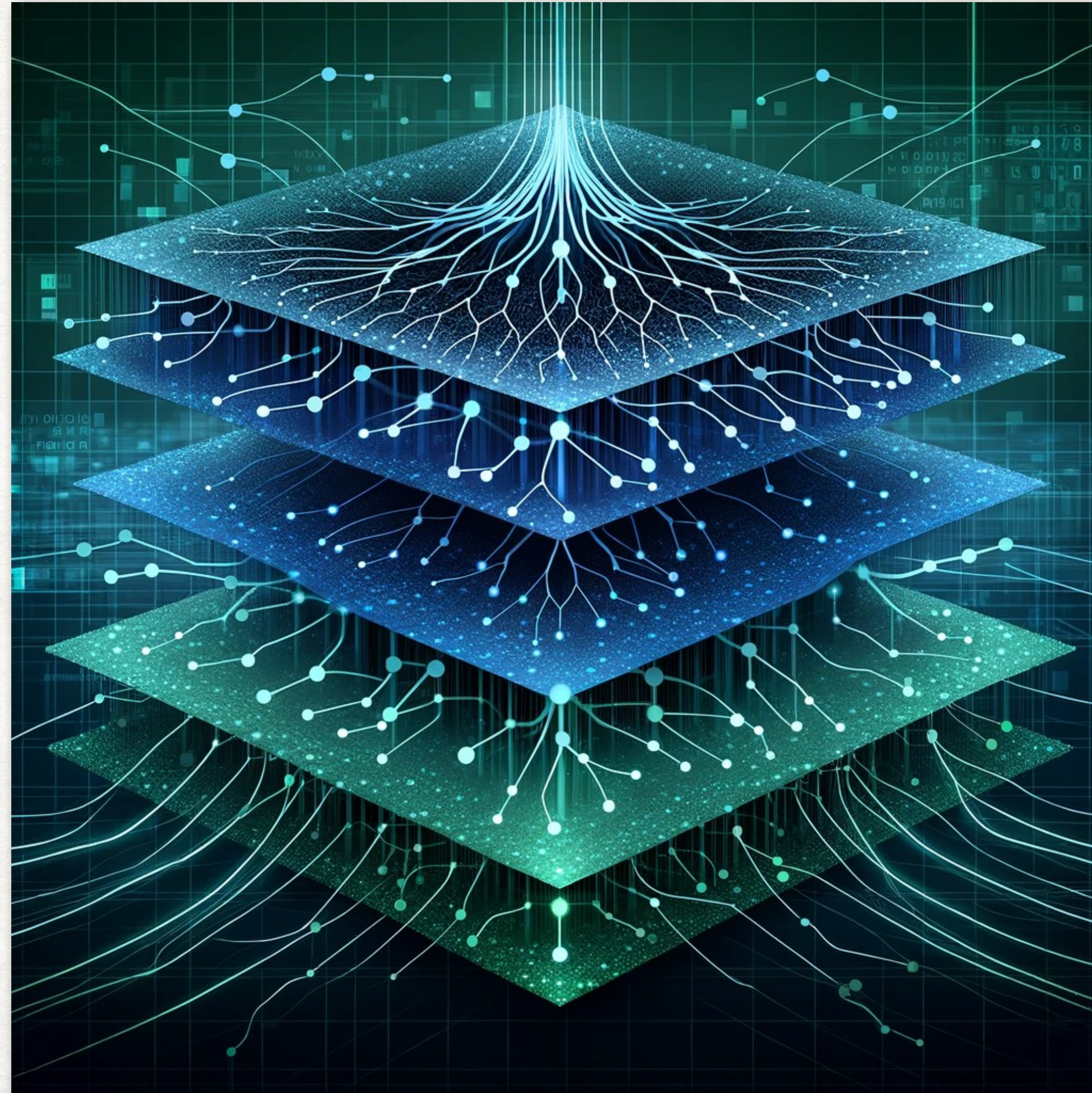
REINFORCEMENT LEARNING - BELLMAN EQUATIONS



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MATRICES

(DEEP) NEURAL NETWORKS



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MATRICES

MATRIX VECTOR MULTIPLICATION

$$\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & \cdots & a_{1n} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & \cdots & a_{2n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{m1} & a_{m2} & \cdots & a_{mn} \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ \vdots \\ b_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11}b_1 + a_{12}b_2 + \cdots + a_{1n}b_n \\ a_{21}b_1 + a_{22}b_2 + \cdots + a_{2n}b_n \\ \vdots \\ a_{m1}b_1 + a_{m2}b_2 + \cdots + a_{mn}b_n \end{pmatrix}$$

MATRICES

MATRIX- MATRIX MULTIPLICATION

$$\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{B} = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & \dots & a_{1n} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & \dots & a_{2n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{m1} & a_{m2} & \dots & a_{mn} \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} b_{11} & b_{12} & \dots & b_{1l} \\ b_{21} & b_{22} & \dots & b_{2l} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ b_{n1} & b_{n2} & \dots & b_{nl} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} a_{11}b_{11} + a_{12}b_{21} + \dots + a_{1n}b_{n1} & a_{11}b_{12} + a_{12}b_{22} + \dots + a_{1n}b_{n2} & \dots & a_{11}b_{1l} + a_{12}b_{2l} + \dots + a_{1n}b_{nl} \\ a_{21}b_{11} + a_{22}b_{21} + \dots + a_{2n}b_{n1} & a_{21}b_{12} + a_{22}b_{22} + \dots + a_{2n}b_{n2} & \dots & a_{21}b_{1l} + a_{22}b_{2l} + \dots + a_{2n}b_{nl} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{m1}b_{11} + a_{m2}b_{21} + \dots + a_{mn}b_{n1} & a_{m1}b_{12} + a_{m2}b_{22} + \dots + a_{mn}b_{n2} & \dots & a_{m1}b_{1l} + a_{m2}b_{2l} + \dots + a_{mn}b_{nl} \end{pmatrix}$$

Vector matrix multiplication is a special case

MATRICES

TO MULTIPLY OR NOT TO MULTIPLY ?

$$AB$$

$$C_{ij} = \sum_{k=1}^n A_{ik} B_{kj}$$

$$A1 \times A2 = B1 \times B2$$

$$A1 \times B2$$

MATRICES

TRANSPOSE

$$(A^T)_{rc} = A_{cr}$$

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$A^T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 4 \\ 2 & 5 \\ 3 & 6 \end{pmatrix}$$

MATRICES

TRANSPOSE

$$(A^T)_{rc} = A_{cr}$$

$$(AB)^T = B^T A^T$$

Dimensions

A1 x K

K x B2

Transpose

K x A1

B2 x K

SUMMARY

PREREQUISITES

- **Derivatives - Optimisation, Gradient Learning**
- **Matrices - Multiplication, transpose**
- **Probabilities - Expectation, Conditional Expectation**



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THANK YOU!